

PERSONAL INITIATIVE IN THE ENTREPRENEURIAL PROCESS

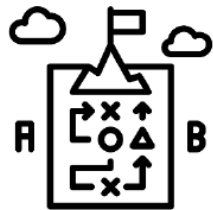
- Your own initiative is necessary at all stages of the entrepreneurial process:



1. Identification of opportunities



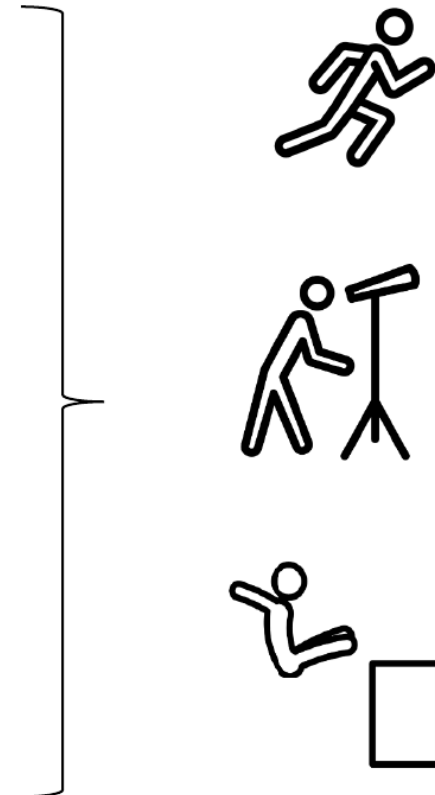
2. Setting a goal

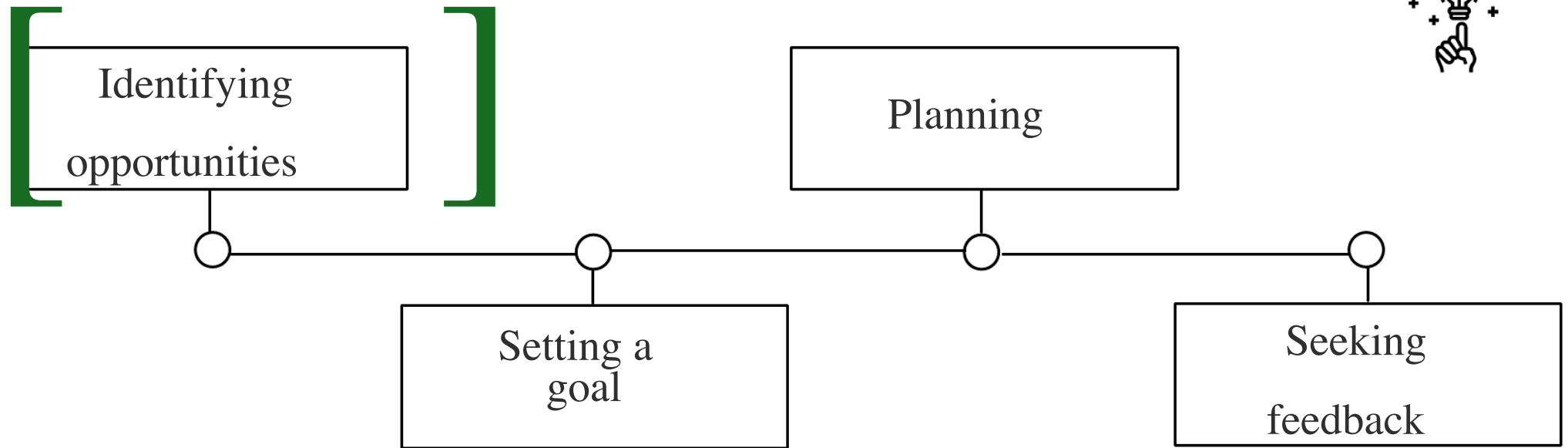


3. Planning



4. Seeking feedback





INNOVATION AND OPPORTUNITY IDENTIFICATION

Do something new that your competitors are not doing!





SELF-ASSESSMENT QUESTIONNAIRE

"Innovation and and opportunity identification"

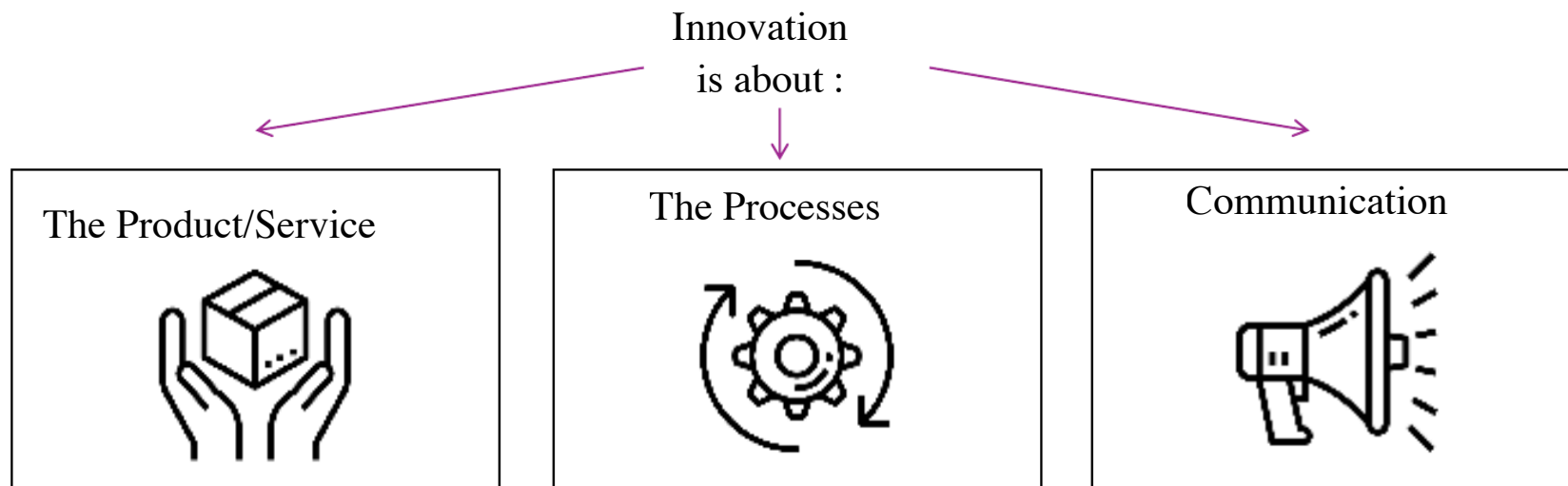
Read the self-assessment
questionnaire on "innovation
and opportunity identification"
and tick the answers.



EVERY BUSINESS CAN AND SHOULD BE IMPROVED



- To improve your business, you need to be innovative. Being innovative means creating ideas which are both new and useful.
- There are 3 areas where you can be innovative to create opportunities



innovative

/ˈɪnəvətɪv/ 

adjective

(of a product, idea, etc.) featuring new methods; advanced and original.

"innovative designs"

- (of a person) introducing new ideas; original and creative in thinking.

"writers who are now viewed as innovative"

synonyms: original, innovatory, innovational, new, novel, fresh, unconventional, unorthodox, of
centre, unusual, unfamiliar, unprecedented, avant-garde, experimental, inventive,
ingenious; [More](#)

INNOVATIVE SOLUTIONS

That evening quail came and covered the camp, and in the morning there was a layer of dew around the camp. When the dew was gone, thin flakes like frost on the ground appeared on the desert floor. When the Israelites saw it, they said to each other, "What is it?" For they did not know what it was.

Moses said to them, "It is the bread the LORD has given you to eat.

Exodus 16: 13-15



THE IMPORTANCE OF INNOVATION

- o Do something new that your competitors are not doing!
- o Vital Importance: **Never stand still** - stay ahead of your competitors to help your business succeed
- o When competitors try to copy you, think of new ideas to ensure your business remains unique!
- o To be innovative you need to identify new business opportunities!





THE IMPORTANCE OF INNOVATION

EXERCISE

Instruction:

In groups of 4 identify why it's so important to innovate in business using one example from all the three areas of innovation in any business:

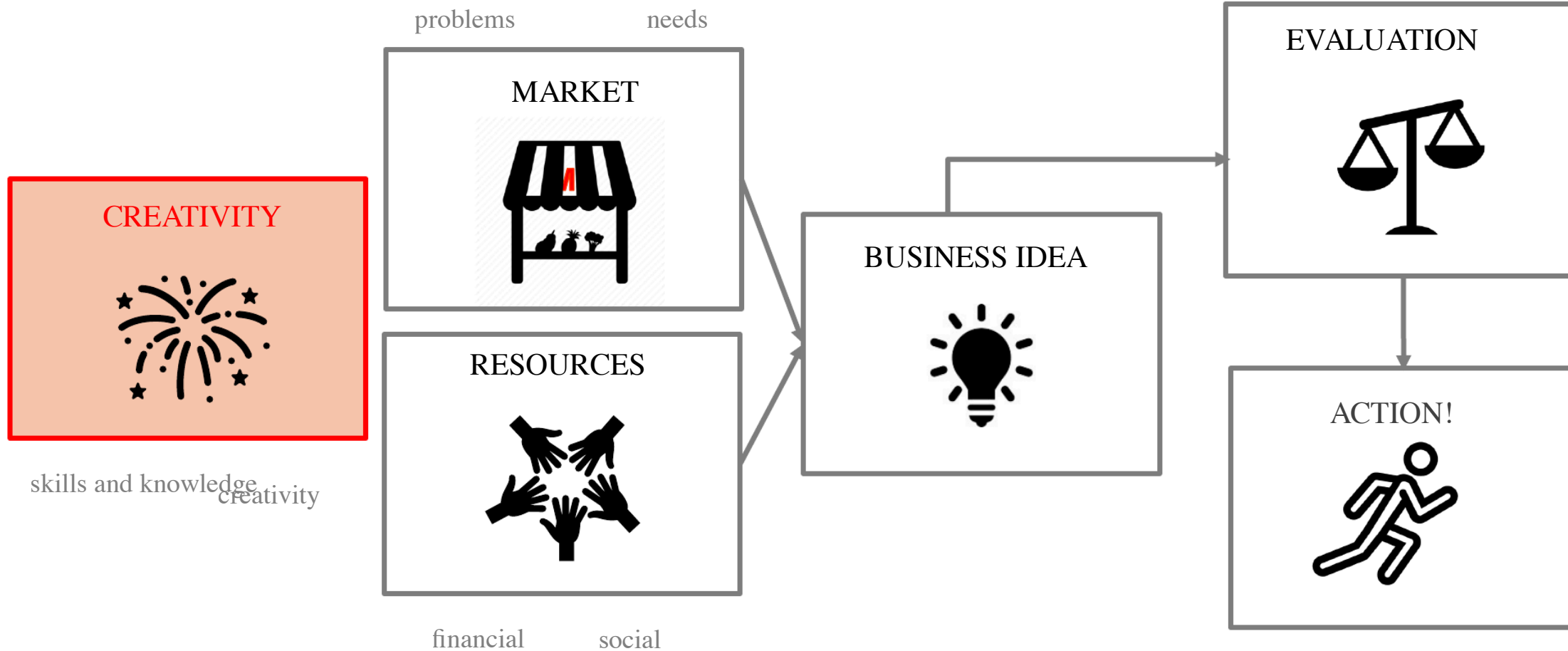
- The Product/Service
- The Processes
- Communication





own / others

Process of Opportunity Identification





THE IMPORTANCE OF INNOVATION

EXERCISE

Instruction:

In groups of 4 identify how you can identify a business opportunity.

Include all forms of research you can think of as well as ways of coming up with ideas yourself.

This step is just about HOW you come up with an idea, don't try to evaluate it, that comes at a later stage.



WHAT YOU NEED TO DO Be Creative



Self-Starting ●

- ! Actively research and brainstorm ideas, look at the needs in the market and where other solutions can be improved on
- ! Avoid "me too" ideas unless you are offering something unique Generate NEW ideas!
- ! Think outside the box. Don't let your current knowledge limit your thoughts

Future-Oriented

- ! Avoid keeping things the same. Think about what might be needed in the future
- ! Think of a way to record the creative ideas you want to pursue in the future

Overcoming Barriers

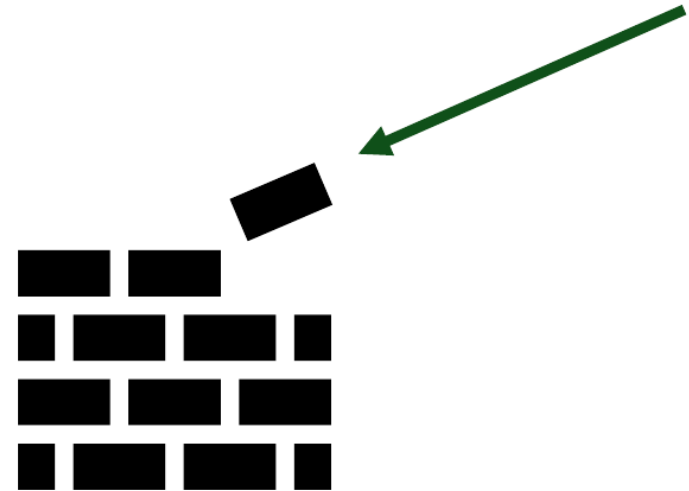
- ! Don't give up on ideas because you aren't sure if they are feasible
- ! Don't allow tradition or convention to get in your way

EXERCISE I: Think Differently and Unconventionally



Instruction

Think of as many alternative uses of a brick as you can. Be creative!



DIFFERENT UNCONVENTIONAL

- Shortly before dawn
Jesus went out to them,
walking on the lake.

Matthew 14: 25



EXERCISE II: Think Differently and Unconventionally

To avoid the seemingly obvious, you can combine different ideas.

INSTRUCTION

Create two new products or services by combining two, three or more objects.
Try to make the products/services as unique as possible!

- Don't evaluate the ideas. You will do that at a later stage.
- Don't be too critical: All ideas are allowed, even ones that seem crazy.
- Avoid ideas that are too detailed or complicated.





THE "SCAMPER" TECHNIQUE

S - Can you replace part of the product/service?

~~Substitute~~

C - Can you combine the product/service with another?

~~Combine~~

A - Adapt Can you adapt the functionality of the product/service?

M - Modify Can you change the size or attributes of the product/service?

P - Put to another use Can you find other areas where the product/service has an alternative use?

E - Can you remove an element from the product/service?

~~Eliminate~~

R - Can you change the idea behind the product/service?

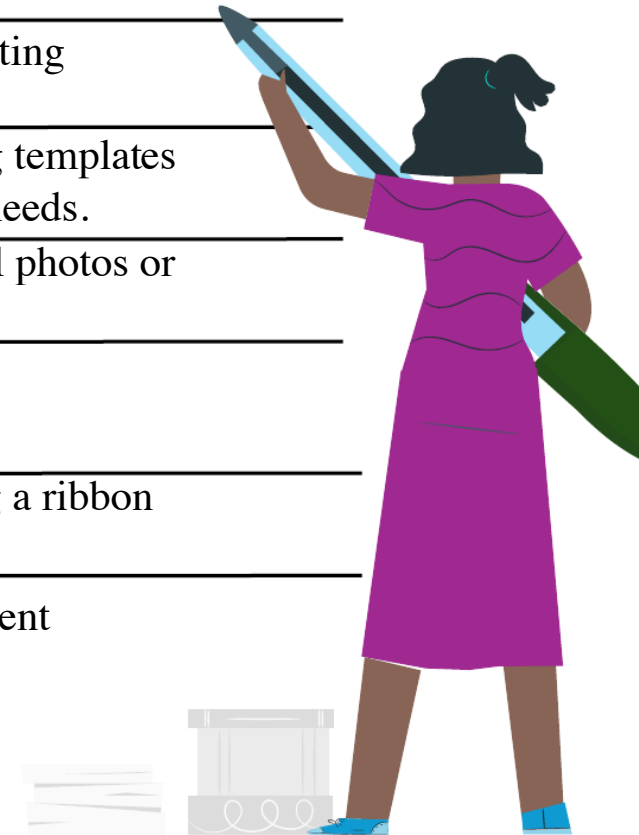
Rearrange



THE "SCAMPER" TECHNIQUE

Example: A Notepad

S - Substitute	Replace paper with recycled materials or waterproof synthetic paper for durability and eco-friendliness.
C - Combine	Combine the notepad with a calendar and planner, integrating sections for scheduling and to-do lists.
A - Adapt	Adapt the notepad for specific professions, such as adding templates for designers, engineers, or chefs to cater to their unique needs.
M - Modify	Modify the cover design to be customizable with personal photos or artwork, appealing to individual tastes.
P - Put to another use	Repurpose the notepad as a sketchbook by using thicker, higher-quality paper suitable for drawing and painting.
E - Eliminate	Eliminate the need for a separate bookmark by integrating a ribbon or elastic band marker.
R - Rearrange	Rearrange the order of pages to include sections for different purposes (notes, tasks, ideas) within one notepad.





EXERCISE III: Think Differently and Unconventionally

Instruction:

Work in **groups of two (02)** and choose a product or service from one of your projects. Can you modify it using the **SCAMPER** technique?

WS 9

EXERCISE

The SCAMPER technique



PRODUCT/SERVICE:		
S - Substitute		
C - Combine		
A - Adapt		
M - Modify		
P - Put to Another Use		
E - Eliminate		
R - Rearrange		